

BERNERA NEWS

A Community Newsletter **The Daily Ceilidh**
in association with

Welcome to the 6th edition of the Bernera News, and our first monthly publication. It has felt very strange not having quite so much to do every other week to get the newsletter to print! Despite the weather being more autumnal at times, we've all enjoyed spending some time outside now a few more of the lockdown restrictions have eased. We hope you've also been making the most of the odd days of sunshine and summery weather.

Talking of summer, thank you so much to everyone who sent us photos for our photographic competition. The winner is revealed on Page 5.

Thanks also to those who have kindly made donations towards our printing costs. We really do appreciate all the support we've received.

If you have something you'd like to share, or a story to tell, please don't hesitate to get in touch. We'd particularly like to hear from those interested in sending us a contribution to Postcards from the Islands, and from those with ideas of what you'd like to see included in our next issues. If you feel able to write something for us that would be great, but we're equally happy to do an "on the sofa" type interview, or even write a piece about something you'd like to read about. In the meantime, thank you once again for all the contributions received so far.

Contact us at: 01851 600 159
Text/Whatsapp: 07958 549784
Email: hello@thedailyceilidh.co.uk
Or visit us online at:
www.thedailyceilidh.co.uk

TEMPORARY ROAD CLOSURE BERNERA BRIDGE

In accordance with the requirements for maintaining and inspecting its bridge assets Comhairle Nan Eilean Siar proposes to undertake invasive investigation works to Bernera Bridge between the hours of **9.30pm and 5.30am over 5 consecutive nights from Monday 10th August till Friday 14th August 2020.**

The Bridge shall be closed to traffic between these hours with allowance made only for emergency vehicles passing through. Persons requiring access across the bridge during the closure period can be escorted through the site on foot by traffic management operatives if they make themselves known beforehand.

Any person who requires further information on this matter should contact: Angus M Gillies, Bridges Engineer. Comhairle nan Eilean Siar, Sandwich Road, Stornoway. Isle of Lewis. HS1 2BW.

Tel 01851 822 726. Email angus.gillies@cne-siar.gov.uk

PHARMACY FIRST

The Community Pharmacy (KJ Macdonald's, Boots and Back) 'Pharmacy First' service is now live in NHS Western Isles, which means Pharmacies can see patients directly for minor ailments and provide things like eye drops, skin creams, antibiotics for urinary or eye infections etc.

Patients can self-refer to the Pharmacy and don't need to speak to their GP Practice for things like this.

THE SALVATION ARMY FOOD BANK

The food bank is still open on a Wednesday and Saturday from 11am - 2pm for those needing extra support in these difficult times.

It runs from the Golf Club in Stornoway, but if anyone is struggling to get into town please contact us at The Daily Ceilidh, in strictest confidence, and we can arrange collection for you.

NHS WESTERN ISLES SERVICES UPDATE

NHS Western Isles has reintroduced a number of clinics recently, as part of the work to resume services. Clinics recently re-started are Audiology, Ophthalmology (glaucoma), Pain and Dermatology.

NHS Western Isles continued to treat patients with urgent conditions and/or requiring emergency treatment across the islands during the

CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

NHS WESTERN ISLES SERVICES UPDATE (CONTD.)

lockdown period, and work is ongoing to resume services as quickly as possible. Ensuring the safety of both patients and staff remains our priority.

The wearing of face masks is a requirement for staff now in all clinical areas and if you attend a clinic or are a named visitor, you will also be required to wear a face mask. At the Western Isles Hospital in Stornoway, you will continue to be directed to your location by security door staff, but will be given your mask when you enter the clinical area that you are attending.

Please ensure that you continue to observe physical distancing whilst in healthcare premises. In outpatient waiting areas, chairs are placed two metres apart, and enhanced cleaning is taking place to ensure the safety of staff and patients.

In terms of cervical screening, anyone who was invited for cervical screening before lockdown should now contact their GP practice to make an appointment. This applies to anyone who was yet to make an appointment or who had made an appointment, which was then cancelled. Appointment invitations and reminders are now also being posted, with invitations sent to those who receive more frequent (non-routine) cervical screening appointments. Invitations to attend routine screening appointments will be issued from September 2020, once NHS Western Isles has caught up with non-routine appointments affected by the pause.

Our Dental Services and our two local optometrists continue to provide more appointments but numbers are still restricted by physical distancing and the enhanced cleaning required between appointments.

ON THE SOFA... CHARLIE MAIN, SEASOH

Virginia Allum chatted to Charlie Main, project manager, from the SEASOH project in a virtual on the sofa session to find out more about this interesting project.



Can you tell us about the Seas of the Outer Hebrides (SEASOH) project you are involved in?

Seas of the Outer Hebrides (SEASOH) is part of a bigger project called MarPAMM which manages marine protected areas. The SEASOH project is a community engagement project, which engages with as many interested people as possible to develop a shared vision for the sea and its management, with a focus on marine protection of areas of the Outer Hebrides.

How have you been able to engage the community in the project?

I've been speaking to a range of different people in various communities, including Uig and Bernera. This has included people who have a stake in the marine environment, such as fishermen and women; people who use the sea commercially; people who enjoy the health benefits of being near or in the sea, and those who forage near the sea edge.

Could you tell us about the survey, which some of our community completed?

The online survey, which was undertaken in March this year, gathered responses about what you, as a community, consider the most important issues around marine environment protection and use. All in all, there were 260 responses from across the Outer Hebrides, 92% of which were from island residents. I also visited Bernera in September 2019, during the Hebrides International Film Festival, to have some initial conversations about the project.

Were there any issues which seemed to be of importance to the community?

One issue which people spoke about was the eyesore that rubbish dumped near the shoreline causes. The people who raised the issue felt that it was something which had a great impact on the marine environment and felt it painted a negative picture for both tourists and residents alike.

The SEASOH project office is located at the UHI, Lews Castle College, Stornoway.
Get in touch to find out about ways to get involved in the project.
Contact the project officer Charlie Main at: charlie.main@uhi.ac.uk

Virginia Allum
Earshader



POSTCARDS FROM THE ISLANDS...

Over the last year I have been working on a set of four short films for the **Between Islands Project** in association with **LEADER** and **An Lanntair**.

The theme of the films was to explore our heritage and the importance of preserving it, while keeping with the ever-changing times. The films were scheduled to be released this summer as part of the Between Islands exhibition in museums across Orkney, Shetland and Lewis. Because of the ongoing situation, the physical exhibition did not open. However, the films are being released online and we hope to gain just as big an audience – if not bigger! – this way.

The idea was to take four island voices, one for each film, and explore different aspects of our heritage and identity. I chose the four topics that I believe are integral to our history: Community, Tradition, Spirit and Change.

The first film, Community, was released online this week and features Professor Frank Rennie as he discusses the changing infrastructures of community and explains how the communities we know and love came to be. He addresses the misconceptions about places such as Lewis, and how these misconceptions were generated through a narrow perspective of the Highlands and Islands. As we know, to fully embrace ourselves in this place takes hard work and dedication. No day on the island is as romantic or easy as some like to believe, but it is also far more rewarding than a simple “escape”. With each day we spend here we live in the footsteps of those who built this land: the paths, the fences, the airidhs. We have an awareness of those who moved from their homes and had their land taken away; we notice everyday the things that surround us, from the shapes in the ground to the movements of the seas.



There is a unique quality to being part of an island community, and that comes with a responsibility to preserve our heritage and simultaneously adapt to the natural changes our communities face. Along with Frank Rennie’s insightful interview, I have included sounds and footage of Bernera. These films feature four island voices but are also a personal piece of work that features parts of my own ideas and identity, and I have aimed to include this in various ways. Throughout the film we hear voices of those who lived in Bernera, such as Neil Iain Macaulay, discuss how and why the villagers in Bosta moved to Kirkibost. Hearing the voices of Bernera men discuss some of the changes the island faced seemed like a perfect example of Frank Rennie’s discussions on change, while incorporating my own heritage of the people who came before me.



I’m excited about the long-awaited release of these films, and hope they accurately represent the importance of our heritage and future. The other three films feature Psalm singer and precentor Isobell Ann Martin, Guga hunter John Dods Macfarlane, and Gaelic singer and teacher Mary Smith. Each voice gives a different perspective of the island, and the films can be found on the Between Islands YouTube channel when they are released in the coming weeks!

Zoe Paterson Macinnes is a filmmaker and visual artist from Bernera. After graduating Edinburgh Napier with a degree in Film she has worked as a freelancer, making documentary shorts, film poems and photographs, mostly based on the Outer Hebrides.

Zoe Paterson Macinnes
Dun Innes



BERNERA IS BUZZING

Lockdown has been challenging for many of us, not least those that have had to shield completely, but signs are that all is again changing here on the islands. Slowly, as more of life moves towards opening up, we have businesses able to more fully deliver their services, from Crofters and building supplies businesses opening their doors, to cafes opening for takeaways or outdoor service.

On Bernera, the fishermen are back in their boats, putting down creels, ready for the season ahead and sheep are being readied for sales at the **Lewis and Harris Auction Mart**, who have advertised their first sales of this year in August and September.

The **Post Office** and shop has been open throughout the lockdown and have offered such vital lifeline services that have kept the community well served, and are now helping to serve tourists too.

Bus services are starting to run and we are pleased to include in this issue a copy of the most recent timetable. This lifeline service has been greatly missed over these past few months.

Self catering accommodation providers have finally been able to welcome their guests back and these tourists are bringing an energy to the beauty spots we haven't seen for months. Whilst many of those working from home instead of offices and juggling childcare have found it to be undoubtedly testing, lockdown has been an opportunity for others to concentrate on new ventures and we've seen everything from masks being made for sale to new garden and handyman services starting up.

This means too that small business owners who live and work on the island have been busy trying to ensure that the lockdown has been an opportunity for regrouping or growth.

Black Bay Studio at Kirkibost Pier has used the time to refurbish their kitchen and lounge, as well as adding more musician accommodation, in time for their first post lockdown booking in September.

Stuart Sutherland of **Graphite Signs**, who has moved premises and installed new equipment in premises in Stornoway over this period, is now fully back to business delivering brand identity to all manner of vehicles and businesses.

Comutiny, a digital media and film company based at Kirkibost Pier, which moved from Birmingham to Bernera last year, has finally had new commissions and can start to grow their business as planned.

Crust like This, the new pizza takeaway is being fitted out in it's roadside location in Leurbost ready for opening in the next few weeks.



The **Bernera Development Trust** has purchased a community trailer and it is available to those shielding and without vehicles. The service is to help residents to get rubbish and items not picked up by the refuse collections, to the skip from outside houses, mindful of social distancing protocols. If this service would be useful to you, please contact Callum Macaulay.

Finally too, some projects that had been delayed by lockdown, have been restarted or even finished, like the **electric charging points** which have been installed at the side of the Bernera Community Centre. The 2 car parking/charging points are operational and awaiting the first users.

Whether you've started something new or renewed an old interest, it is clear that this time has sparked much enterprise and there is still more to come as driving lessons can finally begin again after 24th of August and surely our local **JEM Driving School** are crossing all fingers that this is not delayed.

Whatever the timetable or strains we are placed under, it is great to see our community of business people getting some wind in their sails into the next phase so from the next issue we will be doing a meet the business feature each month. If you have a business or enterprise that you'd like included please get in touch.

PHOTO COMPETITION - "SUMMER"

Thank you to everyone who sent us such fantastic pictures for our recent photographic competition. It was very enjoyable looking through all the photos taken in Bernera and Tir Mor. What a beautiful and photographic place we're all lucky enough to call home! After much deliberation we decided to award first prize to **Angie Currie** of Kirkibost for this beautiful picture.



1st Prize, Angie Currie

We've also decided to award a small prize for 2nd place for this perfectly timed picture by **Linne Macleod**, of Dun Innes.

We'll be in touch shortly to arrange delivery of your prizes!

If you have any photos that you'd like to share with us we'd love to see them. We might even use them in a future publication!



2nd Prize, Linne Macleod

BERNERA BAKES... SUMMER CHRISTMAS SLICE

This month we are having a Christmas slice in summer! This recipe is easy and you can serve it with cream or custard, or both. Yummy. Enjoy.

INGREDIENTS

1 large jar mincemeat
8oz short crust pastry
6oz crumble topping.
 Smoked glass / clear pie dish

METHOD

- Grease dish with butter
 - Add short cust to dish base
 - Spoon in mincemeat
 - Top with crumble topping
Bake for 45 minutes at 180°C



Careen MacLennan
 Kirkibost



GENERAL KNOWLEDGE QUIZ

- Jason's crew on his journeys
- Pilgrim fathers sailed to the New World on the
- Dundee United's home ground
- The oldest man in the bible
- Famous southern Greek Oracle
- Teenage vampire slayer
- Best suits in the world are said to be made in
- Romanic mode of Venetian transport
- Roman god of the underworld and a cartoon dog
- Newest trainline in Scotland
- Pandemic of 1918 to 1920
- A Majestic Drummer
- Worlds first fully double deck passenger plane
- A floral ideology of the 1960's
- Connects the Clyde to the Sound of Jura
- A King's boundary between Wales and England
- Live Aid performed in which two cities simultaneously
- Temple complex on the banks of the Nile
- Dame Vera Lynn was known as the
- C of S School open to all in this Israel city
- A hair style and a fish
- UK's smallest city
- Students throw this in the air on graduation day
- A mythologies gods combined are called a
- The oldest overseas Scottish Institution is what
- Said to be the location for the Sermon on the Mount
- The two colours for the source(s) of the Nile
- Chinese philosophy for living in harmony
- A motorised rickshaw
- The Titanic was which class of Liner

Colin Halliday
 Kirkibost



COUNT YOUR BLESSINGS

'Night-time curfew for Bernera', was the headline that grabbed my attention as I read 'Hebrides News' recently. The report went on to detail that to facilitate essential maintenance work to the Bernera Bridge it required to be closed overnight for the period of five nights during August.



It is a bridge that is well used. A bridge that one immediately associates with Great Bernera. A metal structure that provides a physical link between the island of Great Bernera and mainland Earshader, Lewis.

Yet it may, at times, be a link that we may take for granted. Notwithstanding, its ease of accessibility, provision of utility and continual use.

But as we are now faced with a limited, temporary restriction on its use, we may begin to reflect and recognise just what a benefit it provides to our small, island community.

In a very real sense, this reflection, may mirror our own experience(s) of life.

For many of us, if we were to be totally truthful, this realisation comes after we say goodbye to a loved one for the last time - their wisdom, their humour, their example, their faith, their love and many other character traits and virtues impact our memories of past times, of laughter, challenge, joy and happiness.

The Bible informs us that, *'Every good gift and every perfect gift is from above, and comes down from the Father of lights, with whom there is no variation or shadow of turning'*, **James 1:17**

At times, we too, may not appreciate our beautiful families, that amazing sunset, the wonderful peace we experience at Bosta on a warm Summer's evening as we watch the waves gently lap the shore, all come to us from God.

God is good and we consider His goodness to us in family, health, and community today may we like the hymnwriter, 'Count our blessings, naming them one by one, .. [in order to]... see what God has done!'

Rev Hugh Maurice Stewart
Uig & Bernera



CHURCH UPDATE

Following the revision of Lockdown measures by the Scottish Government the Kirk Session of Bernera Church of Scotland met to discuss the re-opening of the Church. The elders decided that the church should not re-open at this time, subject to review.

VIRTUAL SERVICES.

For those of you with access to the internet, Lochs-in-Bernera Church of Scotland offers regular virtual services as listed below.

Online Sunday Service - 10:30 am

(Available on the Church's Facebook page or Youtube Channel)

Online Sunday School - 12 noon

Online Prayer Meeting - 7 pm each Thursday evening.

Both the online Sunday School and the Prayer Meeting are hosted on video conferencing. They are open to all, please email the Minister at

berneralwuig@btinternet.com to receive a secure invitation.

PASTORAL CARE

The Minister is available 24/7 to offer pastoral care to anyone in the Parish of Bernera whether or not they come to church.

He may be contacted on:

(01851) 672 388 or **07971 057915** or by e-mail at **berneralwuig@btinternet.com**.

